Market Research Report Evaluation

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EDUC 590: Special Topics

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September 2, 2026

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Coursera is an online learning platform that partners with universities and companies to provide courses, professional certificates, degree programs, and other learning opportunities to individuals worldwide (Coursera, n.d.). *The Coursera Global Skills Report 2025 examines* the skill demands reshaping the workforce. The report analyzes data from more than 170 million Coursera learners with content from over 350 universities and industry partners in 109 countries (Coursera, 2025). The report focuses on the rapid adoption of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI), differences in skill proficiency and AI readiness across regions, and the changing skills required for today's workforce, showing how technological advancements are creating new demands across education and the workforce.

The *Coursera Global Skills Report 2025* looks at higher education and workforce development as the main segments of the education market. As today's job market demands different skill sets, colleges and universities want to better prepare students with those new skills, which is where higher education fits into the education market. For example, 95% of employers in the Asia Pacific region believe that industry-aligned micro-credentials provide graduates with immediately applicable job skills (Coursera, 2025). Workforce development is a key area of focus because advancing technology creates new skills needed in the workplace, which makes upskilling and reskilling more important. The report discusses four major groups within these segments: businesses, governments, individual learners, and higher education institutions. Each of these groups can respond to the changing skill demands and benefit from Coursera in different ways. Businesses can incorporate specific modules into employee development programs and determine workforce needs, learners can develop new skills, and governments and higher education institutions can create new opportunities for people to continue learning.

Throughout the report, several key themes highlight how changing technology is impacting education and workforce development. The most prominent key theme and a major finding is GenAI and the growing demand for GenAI skill development courses on Coursera. This growing demand can be seen across many different regions around the world. Latin America and the Caribbean experienced a 425% year-over-year increase in GenAI course enrollment, reinforcing the excitement for digital skills (Coursera, 2025). Other regions also saw a surge in enrollment, with North America up 135% year-over-year and Asia Pacific up 132% year-over-year (Coursera, 2025). These findings show the increasing global demand for AI skills, but also the different rates at which regions are adopting them. The growing enrollment in these courses demonstrates how learners are responding to the changing skills being demanded by the workforce.

As the AI demand is growing worldwide, countries are not equally prepared to respond to that demand. This leads to the next key theme throughout the report, which is the difference in skill proficiency and AI readiness between countries. The *Coursera Global Skills Report 2025* ranked all 109 countries included in the report on a global rank chart. A country's overall rank indicates its combined performance across all three domains: business, technology, and data science courses on Coursera and key economic indices (Coursera, 2025). For these rankings, Switzerland is first, followed by the Netherlands, Sweden, and then Singapore (Coursera, 2025). The applicable countries were also ranked by their AI Maturity Index, which measured how countries rank in AI learning, research, and innovation (Coursera, 2025). For these rankings, Singapore came in first, followed by Denmark, Switzerland, and the United States (Coursera, 2025). On the other end of the spectrum for both rankings are countries such as Sudan and Yemen (Coursera, 2025). These findings show that strong performances in the courses do not

exactly mean that a country is equally prepared for the continued normalization of AI. They highlight the uneven levels of AI readiness and skill development around the world.

Another major finding is that changing workforce demands are making continuous skill development more important. As technology evolves, workplace skills constantly change. This creates growing expectations for workers to upskill and reskill to stay prepared for new roles. As stated in the report, 99% of surveyed employers in North America reported using skills-based hiring practices (Coursera, 2025) and nearly 90% of companies in Brazil anticipate major upskilling efforts over the next five years (Coursera, 2025). The statistics show that employers increasingly consider job-relevant, demonstrated skills when assessing potential employees. These changing requirements are also increasing the importance of micro-credentials and professional certificates. These findings demonstrate that as learners and institutions respond to these changing employer needs, education and workforce development are working more closely together.

Looking ahead, the trends in this report suggest the education market will continue to evolve alongside changing workforce needs. As this report states, generative AI enrollments increased by 195% year over year and surpassed 8 million enrollments, making GenAI the fastest-growing skill category on Coursera (Coursera, 2025). As artificial intelligence becomes more normalized across industries, these skills will grow in importance and drive the need for workers and educators to continuously upskill and reskill to keep pace with changing job requirements. As these expectations shift, micro-credentials and professional certificates will become more valuable as they allow workers to demonstrate these job-specific skills. Coursera can play a major part in this changing workforce and educational environment. Coursera

provides learners with flexible opportunities to expand their knowledge and develop these new, needed skills that will continue to define the future of education and workforce development.

After reviewing the major findings of the *Coursera Global Skills Report 2025*, I came to the conclusion that I agree with Coursera's perspective of the findings and its future projections. These include the growing importance of GenAI skills, the differences in AI readiness across regions, and the need for continuous upskilling and reskilling.

The first finding I agree with Coursera's perspective on is that GenAI skills are becoming increasingly important across many different areas, but especially in the workforce and education landscape. According to the report, GenAI course enrollments increased by 195% year over year and surpassed 8 million enrollments, making GenAI the fastest-growing skill category on Coursera (Coursera, 2025). I agree with this finding because learning how to use AI is becoming an expectation, but simply knowing how to access AI is not enough. Students and workers need to learn how to use AI effectively and adapt it to the field they are using it in. Using artificial intelligence and expecting workers to be skilled in it will not be limited to only those working in technology. Business, education, communication, healthcare, and marketing professions will also need to adapt, creating an expectation that workers develop the AI skills needed in their fields. Developing AI skills now can better prepare learners and workers for a future in which AI knowledge may be expected across many different professions.

The second finding I agree with is Coursera's perspective that AI readiness and skill proficiency vary significantly across different regions and countries. This difference can be seen when comparing the United States, Brazil, and Mexico. While GenAI enrollment increased by 135% in the United States, 242% in Brazil, and 356% in Mexico, the countries rank 4th, 59th, and 54th on Coursera's AI Maturity Index (Coursera, 2025). These statistics show us that AI readiness

and the demand to learn AI skills do not develop at the same rate. They also tell us that even though a country has already started implementing AI into the workplace and education spaces, and has the resources to be prepared for this, it does not mean that it also has the highest percentage of people who want to be prepared for this and learn AI skills. The same can be true in reverse, as countries that are less prepared for AI can still have a high growth in GenAI enrollment. Therefore, I agree that regions should see the differences in AI readiness and not assume that every country is progressing at the same rate.

The third finding that I agree with is Coursera's perspective that continuous upskilling and reskilling will become increasingly necessary as workforce demands continue to change. The report states that 59% of workers are expected to require retraining by 2030 as changes such as technological advancements continue to transform the global labor market (Coursera, 2025). I agree with this finding because learning and developing your skills should not stop once you are in the workforce. As the skills needed for careers continue to change, workers need to continue to develop their skills to adapt to these new expectations.

Based on the findings and future projections in the *Coursera Global Skills Report 2025,* there are many potential implications for education and the workforce over the next 5 to 10 years. If the trends identified in the report continue, changes in technology and the skills needed to use it will likely impact how people prepare for and remain in their careers.

One potential implication is that AI skills will become a standard requirement across the workforce. As the use of AI continues to grow, AI skills will be important across different fields. Workers will be expected to have these skills and understand how to use AI effectively in a way that applies to their job. This could place greater expectations on universities to prepare learners with these skills before they enter the workforce.

Another potential implication is that differences in AI readiness could create larger gaps between countries and workforces. The 109 countries featured in the report show varying levels of AI readiness. If these differences continue over the next 5-10 years, countries with greater access to AI education, technology, and training will be more prepared to benefit from the growing use of AI. Less prepared countries may struggle to keep up, making access to AI skill development more important.

A third possible implication is that when making hiring decisions, employers may place greater importance on demonstrated skills. These changes could mean that the value of traditional degrees alone is no longer enough. A degree might not always show that a worker can still demonstrate those skills. The report states that 99% of surveyed employers in North America are already using skills-based hiring practices (Coursera, 2025). Over the next 5 to 10 years, this could make certificates and microcredentials another way to demonstrate that you currently have the skills needed for a specific job.

Overall, the *Coursera Global Skills Report 2025* shows how advancements in technology are making a lasting impact on education and the workforce. The growing need for AI skills, differences in AI readiness, and the increasing importance of retaining skills show that people across different industries and points of their career or education will need to adapt to these changes. As technology continues to evolve, being prepared with these skills will be even more important. This report shows that learning and adapting will prepare you for success in the future.

References

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